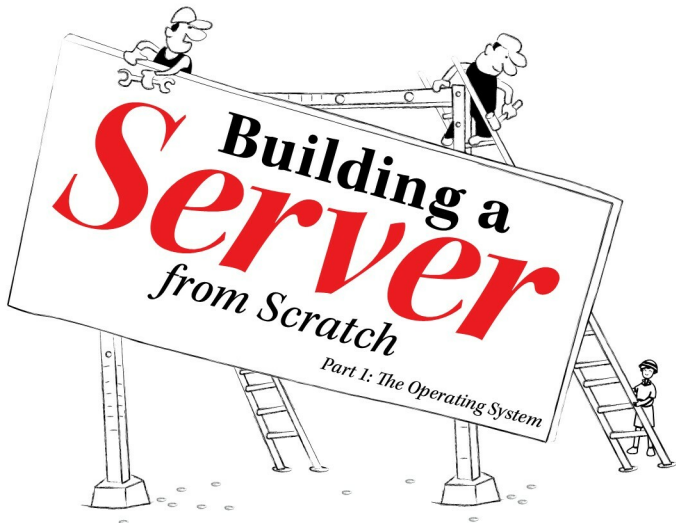




Why buy expensive 'branded' servers? Build one yourself using off-the-shelf hardware.

When enterprises want servers, they buy them. But when hobbyists or small businesses like travel agencies and franchises want servers, they can't. All the servers available commercially are blades, razors, racks, cupboards, etc. The fact is: servers don't have to be in huge air-conditioned rooms. They can run on commodity hardware also. We are going to prove that building a commodity server from scratch (you can make and sell these, if you like) using off-the-shelf hardware can be done for less than Rs 45,000.

As Barack Obama famously said: "Yes, We Can!"

Yes We Can! With 45 grand, we are going to build a server that supports Web, e-mail, virtualisation, media streaming, DNS, PXE, fax, a file server and VNC server roles.

Because of the budget we have, we are going to assemble our own machine (or at least buy the parts ourselves, and get it put together by the local techie). I will recommend specific hardware, including their model numbers.

So let's start buying:

- Processor: Intel Core2 Quad Q6600 2.4GHz @ Rs 9000
- Motherboard: Gigabyte EG45M-DS2H @ Rs 8000
- RAM: Transcend JetRam DDR2-800 800MHz—2x 2GB modules @ Rs 5500 (Rs 2,750 each)
- Hard Disk: 4x Seagate Barracuda 7200RPM 500GB @ Rs 14,000 (Rs 3,500 each)
- Cabinet: iBall i701 Server Cabinet @ Rs 4,000 (Pricey!)
- Keyboard and mouse: Microsoft